

Trick your taste buds

When you eat something, your sense of smell helps you to get the flavor. Block your nose and taste carrot and cucumber. It is hard to tell the difference between them. If you hold a piece of onion under someone's nose and give them mashed apple to eat, they think they are eating onion. This is why you cannot taste your food properly when you have a cold.



Coffee grains are bitter.



Still hungry?

The look of food is important as well as its taste and smell—pink sweetcorn still tastes like sweetcorn, but would you want to eat it?



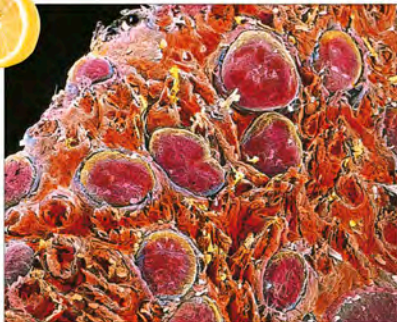
Lemon is sour.



Kippers are salty.



Honey is sweet.



Five tastes

You have around 20,000 taste buds on your tongue, which pick up five different types of taste: salty, sweet, bitter, sour, and umami (savory).

Busy buds

If you look at a tongue through a strong magnifying glass you can see lots of bumps. Around the base of these bumps there are taste buds. Inside them there are special cells that sense taste.

